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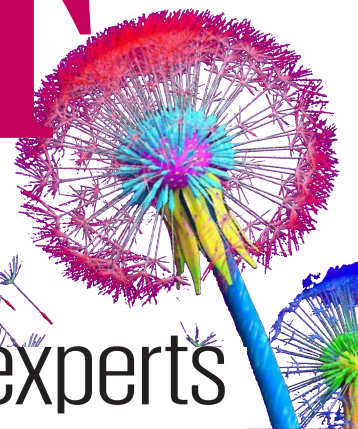
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THEY'RE MAKING APRIL FOOLS OF US

Labour's tax raids and soaring household bills to cost families **£1,000** a year more from next week

By **David Churchill**

Chief Political Correspondent

FAMILIES face a hammering of £1,000 to their annual budgets from next week as Labour's tax raids and inflation-busting bill hikes come into force.

In what is being dubbed 'awful April', council tax, water and energy rates are all set to rise.

Chancellor Rachel Reeves' £25 billion raid on employers' National Insurance will also kick in, with costs being passed on in the form of lower wages and higher prices.

Exclusive analysis for the Daily Mail today lays bare the burden on households and signals a revival of the cost-of-living squeeze, blowing a hole in Labour's promise to put more money in people's pockets.

It also threatens to kill off the predicted meagre economic growth of 1 per cent for this year, which could force Ms Reeves to come back for more tax hikes and spending cuts.

Writing in today's Mail, Tory leader Kemi Badenoch said: 'It's no surprise all these hikes are coming from April 1. Labour are taking the British public for fools. Some of these bills



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PAGES
4-5

Turn to Page 6